

Watering the Seed of Your Future

Romans 12 Promises a Path Into the Perfect Will of God

When we get done with you, you will know how to walk all the way into the perfect plan of God for your life on purpose, simply because you want to go there.

Romans 12 begins:

I beseech you therefore, brethren, by the mercies of God, that ye present your bodies a living sacrifice...

And be not conformed to this world: but be ye transformed by the renewing of your mind...

Paul says the offering of your body as a living sacrifice results in not being conformed to this world, but being transformed by the renewing of your mind so that you may prove the good, acceptable, and perfect will of God.

We know this includes transformation through the Word: no longer thinking like the world, but thinking like God and His Word. But through meditation I saw that Paul extends this further. The good, acceptable, and perfect will of God also includes His personal will for your life.

Some people find good and never leave it. Others find acceptable and never leave it. But some find perfect.

At the Prayer Center, something in me refuses to live with only good or acceptable when I see more in the Word of God. It will not rest until we have what God says is available.

The Worst Death Is Hunger Without Truth

Many people do not stop at good or acceptable because they lack hunger for God. They stop because the enemy deceives them, and they do not know how to go further.

There is no worse slow death than living this life craving and thirsting after God and never being taught how that hunger can be quenched.

Give me my day in court. If I fail, let it be because the truth was preached to me, I saw what to do, and I rejected it. Do not let me fail because someone put me in a holding tank and stripped me of truth.

The good, acceptable, and perfect will of God works in two realms. First, there is your personal transformation to the Word: healing, righteousness, worship, praise, faith, and the basic truths of your walk with God. Second, there is the good, acceptable, and perfect will for your personal calling.

Grace Gives Every Member a Different Office

Paul continues:

For I say, through the grace given unto me, to every man that is among you...

Grace is the unmerited, unearned favor of God. Paul is speaking out of the grace given to him. He says we should not think of ourselves more highly than we ought, but think soberly according as God has dealt to every man the measure of faith.

Then he says we have many members in one body, and all members do not have the same office. We are one body in Christ, members one of another, with gifts differing according to the grace given to us.

You and I are individual members in the vast body of Christ. Our gifts differ, not by our choosing, but by the unmerited favor of God. In eternity past, God separated us to our respective calls and gave each of us an office to fulfill by grace.

No one should think more highly of himself because of his office. You did not choose your calling; He did. Helps, governments, apostles, teachers, pastors, and miracle ministries are all important to the body. Your office was given by grace, so humble yourself.

The Measure of Faith Fits the Measure of Your Call

Paul says to think soberly according as God has dealt to every man the measure of faith.

The body of Christ is like a pie divided into many measures. Each part is one measure, and all the measures together make one whole. The body of Christ consists of many measures, and each believer fills one of them. When all those measures work together, they form a devil-stomping, mountain-moving body of Christ.

You have your measure, and I have mine. Helps, governments, counseling, tongues, intercession, miracle ministries, and other offices have different measures and equippings. But every believer has been given grace, separated to a measure in the body, and given enough faith to fulfill that call.

You are not given the measure of faith to fulfill my call. You are given the measure of faith to fulfill yours.

That is why you can finish your course. God deposited enough faith in your spirit for what He called you to do.

Your Calling Was Deposited in Seed Form

If God has deposited the measure of faith in your spirit, why do so many believers wander almost aimlessly, defeated from place to place? Why do so few fulfill their ministries to full potential?

Because the measure of faith was deposited in seed form.

When God deposited the incorruptible seed in your spirit at the new birth, it carried a program and a diagram, like any seed. Crack open a kernel of corn and you may not see a stalk, but the image and program for the stalk and ears of corn are in the seed.

When you were born again of incorruptible seed, God deposited the program for what your ministry is to become and everything He called you to do. Included in that measure of faith is the ability to receive every blessing redeemed for you through the cross.

But it is in seed form.

Praying in Tongues Waters the Seed of Your Call

Jesus said seed falls on different kinds of ground: wayside, stony, thorny, and good. Some seed is choked, some withers, and some produces thirty, sixty, and a hundredfold. That is good, acceptable, and perfect will again.

If your ground is dry and parched, it is hard for the seed to germinate. The cares of this world, the deceitfulness of riches, and the lusts of other things can choke the call of God until it produces very little.

But there is a way to throw water on your seed.

The twin sister to watering the seed is meditation in the Word. Jesus said:

He that believeth on me, as the scripture hath said, out of his belly shall flow rivers of living water.

The Holy Spirit is likened to water. Every time you pray in tongues, you water, germinate, cultivate, and nurture the seed so the image inside it can come forth. That includes your call.

Therefore Means Romans 12 Depends on Romans 8

Paul says, "I beseech you therefore." When you see the word "therefore," you should ask what it is there for.

Paul is saying, "Based on what I have already told you, present your body as a living sacrifice." He would not ask you to offer your body unless he had already told you how to do it.

That sends us back to Romans 8.

You can quit sinning. You can quit the habits that bind you. You may need to build yourself up because your emotions are weak and demand pacification, but you can build yourself to the place where you can obey God and walk in His plan.

The devil is after the seed. He wants you fruitless the rest of your life. If I were you, I would not give it to him.

The Spirit Helps Our Weaknesses and Prays God's Plan

Romans 8 says creation itself will be delivered from the bondage of corruption into the glorious liberty of the children of God. Creation groans and travails because of the imperfection brought by Adam's fall.

Not only creation, but we also, who have the firstfruits of the Spirit, groan within ourselves, waiting for the adoption to be completed at the redemption of our bodies.

Meanwhile, we live in an imperfect creation and in a body still capable of sinning. So God gave us the Holy Spirit to help our weaknesses:

Likewise the Spirit also helpeth our infirmities: for we know not what we should pray for as we ought...

The Spirit helps our infirmities: our weaknesses in the flesh, our inability to produce results because of the limitations imposed by this body. He makes intercession for us with groanings that cannot be uttered.

He that searches the heart knows the mind of the Spirit and makes intercession for the saints according to the will of God. The "mind" of the Spirit is the plan of the Spirit: God's plan as it applies to your generation and your life.

The Holy Spirit Knows Your Place in God's Purpose

God's overall purpose spans creation, redemption, and the ages. But the Holy Spirit knows your place in that purpose. He knows the mind of God toward this generation, toward Tulsa, toward this church, and toward your individual life.

He is the only One qualified to make successful intercession for your life according to the will of God.

You cannot pray in tongues for two hours without Him working in you. You may not know what you are saying, but He does. He knows your ministry to the end of your life. He knows the particulars between now and then. If God showed some people everything He wants them to do, they would go home saying, "Nobody could do that."

So the Holy Spirit searches the heart, knows the entire plan of God, and makes intercession for you as an individual. That is why Romans 8:28 can say:

And we know that all things work together for good to them that love God, to them who are the called according to his purpose.

All things work together for good when you are engaging God's plan, one phase at a time.

Praying in Tongues Purchases Futures in the Spirit

Praying in tongues is a major key to turning the Holy Spirit loose into your future.

When you buy futures in the natural, you purchase something now for a future outcome. When you pray in the Holy Ghost, you are purchasing futures in the Spirit. The Holy Spirit runs ahead of you, working things together for good to those who love God and are called according to His purpose.

That is why the devil gets so many people out of prayer. Look at what they are doing now. Many who stopped praying drifted into fruitlessness.

If you hang around here, I will keep whipping you back into prayer. Many of us do not have enough self-discipline because the things of this life feel heavier. But I want all things to begin to work together for your good according to God's purpose.

The Leadership of the Spirit Grows Stronger Than Passing Impressions

Many people think the leadership of the Spirit means God leads them in every tiny natural detail as if they had no free will. They will not buy a loaf of bread unless the Holy Spirit tells them which loaf to buy. They think that is spirituality.

But spirituality is a person seasoned in the fruit of the Spirit: longsuffering, forgiveness, peace, righteousness, and understanding.

Does God lead me? Yes. He talks to me all the time about things pertaining to the Spirit. But we can become immature emotional creatures and call every impression leadership, until we are led off into the wild blue yonder.

In my early days, my prayer life fluctuated. Sometimes I prayed four, six, or seven hours a day. Other times, while preaching in the field, I hardly prayed for a month or two. I was condemned half the time, wondering if God would use me because I had not prayed much the week before.

Then He taught me a valuable lesson: God does not fellowship with the cubicle hours you spend in the prayer closet. He fellowships with the change those hours produce.

If you pray one day in a year and it produces real change, He fellowships with the change. He does not condemn you for the time you did not pray. The reward is set before you, and He loves you.

The same is true with fasting. He is not impressed with sacrifice for sacrifice's sake. He delights in obedience and fellowships with the change produced.

Direction Emerges as the Seed Germinates

As I prayed in tongues through those early days, leadership began to come. You cannot miss it if you keep praying in the Holy Ghost. The seed germinates, and soon you can see what kind of seed is coming up.

Direction is instilled in your spirit. If you are supposed to go do a work in Mexico, that direction drops into you. The more you pray, the more it grows. It stops being a passing, weak impression and becomes something that takes you over.

Eventually you cannot think about anything else until you pack your bags. Money does not matter. Nothing matters. You must quench that inward craving by obeying the direction.

Unless you get carnal, you will not miss it. The call will grow on you like a tree if you remain constant in prayer, worship, and meditation in the Word.

I have felt the teacher in me for years. I have felt workings of miracles in my spirit. They have never gone away. You will not have to wonder forever what you are called to do. It will grow on you.

Faithfulness in Prayer Prepares You to Serve the Body

Do not go to a church where they will not call you back into prayer. You need it.

Can people find God's plan without this? Yes. You can receive anything from God if you can believe Him for it. But I am giving you biblical principles that can take you from where you are to where God says you can be, on purpose.

We are part of a team. Some people have stopped coming because they say, "There is more to things than just praying." Listen: by the time you are delivered enough from the flesh to work in the programs without causing problems, God will have plenty for you to do.

You wonder, "Will God ever use me?" If you remain faithful a little longer, He will work you hard. We need trained people.

When direction begins to come, take it. Work in the office, the facet, the place in the church God opens. Present yourself and begin to serve.

You can tell the difference between people building a career in the kingdom and people offering their gifts as servants. Career-builders bounce from church to church if they are not exalted. Servants build the body.

I want you to be used. And if you remain faithful, you will be. For now, have enough faith to direct your energy into prayer.